

19.7 Summary and Notes

19.7.1 Summary

Idea.

1. Omitting regressors biases $\hat{\beta}_1^S$ by $\Pi\beta_2$ and inflates s^2 , while the covariances look exactly as the short model claims (Theorem 19.1.2). Irrelevant regressors cost only variance (Theorem 19.1.3).
2. The short regression has the smaller mean squared error matrix iff $\gamma \leq 1$; at the design points the threshold is p_2 (Theorem 19.1.5).
3. Under $\text{Cov}(\mathbf{Y}) = \sigma^2\mathbf{V}$ the usual variance estimate is off by a factor bounded by eigenvalue ratios of $\mathbf{V}$ (Theorem 19.2.2), while the efficiency loss is bounded by Kantorovich's constant (Theorem 19.2.3).
4. With non-normal errors and $\max_i h_{ii} \rightarrow 0$, linear estimates are asymptotically normal and t and F tests asymptotically valid (Theorem 19.3.2); leverage bounds the finite-sample skewness and kurtosis (Proposition 19.3.3).
5. Intervals for σ^2 , variance-ratio tests and prediction intervals stay wrong in large samples (Proposition 19.3.4, Proposition 12.3.3); quadratic balance protects F tests (Proposition 19.3.5).
6. One contaminated case moves $\hat{\beta}$ by a leverage factor times its residual, hides itself in the fit (Theorem 19.4.1), and can move the estimate arbitrarily far (Proposition 19.4.2).
7. With random regressors and a curved mean, least squares estimates the population projection with a sandwich covariance that the usual formula misses (Proposition 19.5.1, Theorem 19.5.2).
8. Collinearity breaks no assumption but inflates the variance of coefficients and of predictions against the pattern of the data (Proposition 19.6.1).

19.7.2 Notes and sources

Coverage. The chapter covers the topics of Seber and Lee (2003, chapter 9) with its own arguments, and adds Theorem 19.1.5, Proposition 19.3.3, the limiting coverages and the breakdown point. Measurement error is in [Chapter 24](#) (rounding in [Section 19.5](#)), perturbation theory in [Chapter 10](#).

Underfitting and overfitting. The omitted-variable formula is classical; it is Proposition 5.7.2 in Chapter 5. The criterion $\gamma \leq 1$ for the restricted estimator to have the smaller mean squared error matrix is due to Toro-Vizcarrondo and Wallace (1968) (in their notation, with the factor $1/2$ in the noncentrality, the condition reads $\lambda \leq 1/2$), who also proposed testing it with the noncentral F distribution. Pretest estimators, which choose between the two models from the data, are taken up with model selection in [Section 29.2](#) and [Section 29.5](#).

Wrong covariance. The bounds on the bias of the usual variance estimate are Swindel's (1968). The efficiency bound of Theorem 19.2.3 rests on Kantorovich's inequality. The sharp bound for the determinant of the whole covariance matrix is due to Bloomfield and Watson (1975) and Knott (1975). Grenander (1954) showed that least squares is asymptotically effi-

cient for polynomial trends under stationary errors, the phenomenon of Example (A trend with autocorrelated errors). Kruskal's (1968) condition for exact equality is Theorem 6.9.3.

Non-normality. The Lindeberg–Feller theorem is in Billingsley (1995), and Cramér–Wold, Slutsky and continuous mapping in van der Vaart (1998). The leverage condition $h_n^* \rightarrow 0$ is the one used by Huber (1973) in his asymptotic theory of robust regression. That tests on variances are sensitive to non-normality while tests on means are not was emphasized by Box (1953). Box and Watson (1962) and Atiqullah (1962) studied the regression F test through its first two moments, and Atiqullah introduced quadratic balance. Proposition 19.3.5 is a compact version of their calculation.

Outliers and breakdown. The breakdown point in its finite-sample form is from Donoho and Huber (1983), and the influence function from Hampel (1974). Regression estimators with breakdown point near one half exist, least median of squares (Rousseeuw 1984) being the first. The stack loss data are from Brownlee (1965), and their last observation is a much-analysed outlier. [Chapter 20](#) develops diagnostics for such cases.

Random regressors. The view of least squares as estimating a best linear approximation, with a sandwich covariance that the usual formula gets wrong, is due to White (1980). Berkson (1950) distinguished controlled regressors from regressors measured with error. Longley's (1967) data are the standard example of severe collinearity.

19.7.3 References

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